Business Strategy Internship

Proposal Template

INSTRUCTIONS

To fill out this template, download a copy to your computer and save as a Word document. You may need a copy of your completed proposal in Word format if your proposal requires any revisions, so make sure to save two versions: a Word version alongside a PDF copy.
Your project content should be at least 3-5 pages in length for one 4-6 month internship unit. Larger projects may exceed this page count.
Once complete, upload the PDF version of your completed proposal to the Mitacs online Registration and Application Portal (RAP).
Do not modify or remove text or instructions in each section/subsection **or reformat** this form in any way. A modified form will result in a delay in the internship evaluation process.
All sections of the proposal form must be complete to be considered for the program.
Read the Application Guide (Appendix A) starting on page 4 and **Appendix B on page 6** to learn more about the selection criteria that will be used to evaluate your proposal.

DECLARATIONS

Mitacs **will not approve a BSI application** if the intern listed on the proposal has a position of ownership, employment, or influence over the daily operations of the partner organization. Interns with close family or intimate relationships with academic supervisors or employees of the partner organization are also ineligible. Any other real or perceived conflict of interest (COI) - for example, **past intern employment at the partner organization** - **must** be disclosed to Mitacs during the application process using the Intern Eligibility and Conflict of Interest Declaration Form. Academic supervisors must disclose any COIs through the Academic Institution Acknowledgement of COI(s) Form, and submit this documentation on behalf of their post-secondary institution when applying through the Registration and Application Portal (RAP).

Mitacs will first determine if BSI program rules are satisfied, and if so Mitacs will then review the COI to determine whether mitigations can be enacted to manage the COI. If a COI does exist, we suggest that you contact your Mitacs Advisor prior to starting an application to ensure that the participants in this project are eligible for the program. Please view the Mitacs Conflict of Interest Policy for more information.

PLEASE NOTE: Failure to disclose a COI will:
- **Delay the project evaluation process**.
- **Require submission of a COI mitigation approach** satisfactory to Mitacs before project work initiates or continues.
- **Risk forced withdrawal from the BSI program**, should a satisfactory mitigation plan not be reached.

Have any applicants declared a COI via the appropriate documentation? ☐ **Yes, an intern** ☐ **Yes, an academic supervisor** ☒ **No**

Please indicate if any of the below statements are true.
- ☐ One or more named interns self-declares as an Indigenous person.
- ☐ The partner organization is a for-profit organization with self-identifying Indigenous persons who hold 50% or greater ownership shares.
- ☐ The partner organization is a not-for-profit with board membership consisting of 50% or greater self-identifying Indigenous persons.
- ☐ The partner organization is a not-for-profit whose core mandate includes Indigenous community impact or serving Indigenous communities.

** If any of the above statements are true, your organization may be eligible for enhanced leveraging via the Mitacs Indigenous Pathways Initiative. Please check with your Mitacs Advisor for more information.*

Please select all the types of innovation you will significantly impact through your project. Refer to the following definition of innovation for further information: Defining innovation - OECD.

☐ Product innovation ☒ Process innovation ☐ Marketing innovation ☐ Organizational innovation

2. Project Details

☐ **I confirm that I have read Mitacs' Policy on the Use of Artificial Intelligence in Proposal Development and Review**
https://www.mitacs.ca/wp-content/uploads/2025/01/Mitacs-AI-Research-Policy.pdf

2.1 PROJECT DESCRIPTION

2.1.a. Background (What problem needs to be solved?)

Provide an overview and describe the main activities of the partner organization. Explain the innovation challenge or improvement priority that the partner needs to solve. Specify how this project will help the partner organization address those challenges in a way that goes beyond day-to-day business operations/activities. Describe what kind of expertise is required to solve the problem.

Local Connect is developing a Reverse Marketplace platform focused on solving one of the biggest gaps in regional food systems: the lack of shared commercial purchasing data.

Today, critical purchasing information about what restaurants, grocers, and foodservice operations are actually buying is held privately by large distributors like Sysco and Gordon Food Service. Local farms, food manufacturers, and regional suppliers often have little visibility into real commercial demand, making it difficult to know what products to grow, produce, or scale. This disconnect creates waste, inefficiencies, missed sales opportunities, and limits the growth of regional food systems.

Through extensive market research conducted during the Lab2Market Validate program, Local Connect identified that many suppliers are not struggling because of product quality or lack of demand, but because there is no shared system that clearly communicates what commercial buyers actually need.

The Reverse Marketplace solves this problem by aggregating purchasing data from restaurants, grocers, and foodservice operations to create anonymized regional demand insights. By mapping what products are being purchased, in what volumes, and how demand changes over time, the platform gives producers clearer insight into the commercial market.

The goal is to create a more coordinated and efficient food system where suppliers can make better production decisions, reduce waste, improve forecasting, and scale with greater confidence while helping commercial buyers access stronger regional supply networks.

2.1.b. Objectives and Approach (How will the problem be solved?)

State the objectives for this project and explain how you plan to accomplish them. Enough detail should be provided so that it is clear whether the described approach is appropriate to achieve each objective. For projects with more than one intern, clearly explain which objective(s) each intern will work on.

1. **Onboard Commercial Buyers and Collect Purchasing Data**
   Secure participation from restaurants, grocers, and foodservice operations and begin collecting real purchasing data including invoices, order guides, and product demand trends.
2. **Build the Initial Regional Demand Dataset**
   Aggregate and organize purchasing data into a functional regional demand map showing high-volume products, recurring purchasing trends, and category demand across participating buyers.
3. **Validate Supplier Demand Insights**
   Share anonymized demand insights with local farms, manufacturers, and suppliers to validate whether the platform helps improve production planning, sales opportunities, and market visibility.
4. **Test Reverse Marketplace Functionality**
   Pilot direct supplier engagement using verified demand signals by matching suppliers with identified commercial purchasing opportunities and measuring participation, fulfillment interest, and buyer response.

2.1.c. Timeline (Who will solve the problem and how much effort will be required?)

Insert a timeline showing ***which task(s)*** *will be performed* ***when****, and by* ***which intern*** *in order to achieve the objectives stated above (consider breaking this down by week for shorter projects or by month for longer projects via a Gantt chart). Ensure there are no gaps in the timeline and that the effort required to complete each task matches the amount of time allocated for each intern.*

Workstream	Month 1	Month 2	Month 3	Month 4	Outcomes
Onboard commercial buyers and collect purchasing data: -identify and recruit pilot buyers -collect purchasing invoices via our MVP platform -standardize inputs					Onboard 15–20 restaurants, grocers, and foodservice operations contributing recurring purchasing data to the platform within the test region. (Kelowna, BC)
Build the initial regional demand data set -map pilot region purchasing. Creating a map of what produce items are being purchased and at what quantity					Aggregate and categorize over 250 produce purchasing line items and identify at least 25 high-volume produce SKUs commonly purchased within the region.
Validate demand with suppliers -share this data with					Share anonymized produce demand reports with at least 10 regional farms and growers and

suppliers, identifying the capacity they can support. Gather supplier feedback of value around future forecasting and planning. Identify supply gaps and opportunities for agricultural expansion.					secure feedback confirming the data improves crop planning, forecasting, and market visibility.
Facilitate transactions using platform driven data: -using the reverse marketplace model facilitate transactions using the platform. Ie. connect a buyer request with a producer.					Facilitate 5 supplier-buyer transactions using the reverse marketplace model.

2.1.d. Deliverables (What does success look like?)

*<u>**List the deliverables or tangible results**</u> you expect from the project and identify which intern is responsible for it. For example, will you develop a new patent/prototype/product/service, business model, business process, or will you access new markets? Will the intern be expected to produce a report, evaluation, presentation, etc.?*

- Onboard 15-20 buyer accounts in the interior of BC
- Create a map of 250 aggregated line items and identify 25 produce SKUS that can be diverted from national supply chains to local.
- Secure validation from suppliers indicating this type of models improves efficiencies around forecasting and future planning
- Facilitate 5 or more transactions using the reverse marketplace model.

2.2 INTERNSHIP BENEFITS

2.2.a. Benefits and Impacts to Canada

If this project potentially impacts broader challenges that society or the industry faces, please describe how the project will help address these challenges. Why are these contributions important?

Local Connect's demand-driven model creates significant value for both the Canadian agriculture and foodservice sectors by addressing one of the largest gaps in regional food systems: the lack of visibility into commercial purchasing demand.

At its core, the platform gives small and mid-sized producers access to market intelligence that has historically only been available to large distributors. By aggregating purchasing trends from restaurants, grocers, and foodservice operations, producers gain clearer insight into what commercial buyers actually need. This allows farms and manufacturers to make more informed production decisions, improve forecasting, and reduce the uncertainty involved in crop planning. Rather than guessing what to grow, producers can align planting and production decisions with verified regional demand.

The model also creates strong benefits for foodservice operators. Increasing access to regional suppliers helps restaurants and grocers source fresher products with shorter supply chains, improving product quality, shelf life, and reducing spoilage. Redirecting a portion of food spend toward local producers also strengthens regional economies and supports the long-term sustainability of Canadian agriculture.

Additionally, improved access to regional purchasing data has the potential to reduce inefficiencies throughout the food system. Better alignment between supply and demand may help lower crop waste, improve fulfillment consistency, and create more stable production cycles for growers.

The platform also supports broader entrepreneurial and economic opportunities within regional food systems. Wholesale distribution, aggregation, and logistics models are fundamentally dependent on reliable demand visibility. By identifying consistent high-volume purchasing trends, Local Connect helps reduce risk for wholesalers, distributors, and food entrepreneurs looking to build infrastructure around regional food supply chains.

The same principle applies to purchasing models such as Group Purchasing Organizations (GPOs). Large national distributors already leverage centralized purchasing data to create pricing efficiencies at scale, but this infrastructure does not currently exist at a regional level for local food systems. By creating a shared regional demand dataset, Local Connect aims to lay the groundwork for more coordinated purchasing models that could improve supplier access, strengthen regional supply chains, and help lower costs for commercial buyers.

2.2.b. Benefits to the Intern(s)

Explain how participating in this project aligns with the academic studies of the intern(s). How is participating in the project expected to benefit their future career(s)? For example, will they expand their professional network, gain knowledge in a business context, or develop skills in problem-solving, communication, project management, creative thinking, etc.?

Lab2Market: (i) trains highly qualified people (HQP) with the skills to transform research-based ideas into innovative solutions with broad social, environmental and health impact; (ii) reduces the time and risk for commercialization, creating more and better research-based ventures and IP licensing opportunities; and (iii) significantly enhances the innovation capabilities of Canadian business, boosting productivity and economic growth.

The program increases an intern's skills and competencies in innovation and entrepreneurship including critical thinking, problem solving, and adaptability; develops their peer network with individuals from across the country; and, provides mentorship opportunities within the business community.

Currently, post-docs and students at the masters, doctoral, and even advanced undergraduate levels are, in effect, apprenticed to senior scholars and learn their research craft. However, most opportunities will be with business, non-profits and the public sector (61% of Canadian Ph.D graduates are employed outside the PSE sector - Conference Board) L2M provides the foundations for "practical" applications of research expertise and the diverse "soft skills" these opportunities demand. In addition, most leading professors undertaking research in university labs are tenured and less likely to leave their jobs to become full-time entrepreneurs who commercialize research. The L2M Launch program helps address both of these issues by creating opportunities for the students and post-docs outside of the PSE sector and be the vectors of commercialization of research developed in university labs. Even for participants who return to academia, they will be better able to identify high potential commercialization opportunities, know the steps to take, and will support students and other researchers in this effort. Over time, this will have a huge multiplier effect on the program through the students in each researcher's program.

2.3 INTERNSHIP ENVIRONMENT

2.3.a. Description of the Academic Internship Environment

*i. Please describe the nature of academic supervision during the internship period. Explain the **type and frequency of interactions** (e.g., meetings, phone calls, etc.) between the intern and academic supervisor.*

ii. Will the project make use of the resources and/or facilities of the academic institution? If so, please describe.

My academic supervisors bring invaluable expertise that directly supports both the project and my personal development as an entrepreneur. Dr. Kimberly Thomas-François provides deep insight into local food systems, sustainability, and community-based food networks, helping shape the research foundation behind the Local Connect. Her experience ensures that our model remains grounded in real data and aligns with regional food security and sustainability goals.

David Carter brings deep experience in tourism entrepreneurship and regional economic development, shaped by his work with TRU's Tourism Innovation Lab supporting early-stage startups. His expertise connects market development, business incubation, and destination branding, offering insight into how local food distribution can drive broader regional growth. David's guidance helps translate this project's operational improvements into a scalable model for entrepreneurial innovation and community resilience within the local food economy.

Together, their mentorship bridges academic research and industry application—allowing me to combine food systems theory, tourism dynamics, and entrepreneurial execution into a project that strengthens both local supply chains and regional economic resilience.

The Lab2Market Launch program would benefit me as an intern by helping me strengthen the practical skills needed to take Local Connect from a validated concept to a scalable business. The program would give me direct exposure to experienced entrepreneurs, mentors, and operators who have built and commercialized real ventures, while also helping me improve my abilities in execution, strategic thinking, business development, and innovation leadership. It would also expand my network across Canada and connect me with other founders and innovators working on ambitious projects in different sectors. Most importantly, Launch would give me the structure, mentorship, and support needed to continue building a technology platform that addresses a real systems-level problem while accelerating my growth as an entrepreneur capable of leading complex, high-impact projects.

2.3.b. Description of the Partner Internship Environment

i. Please state the nature of the partner interaction: ☐ *Onsite* ☐ *Virtual* ☐ *Hybrid*

ii. Describe the working environment at the partner organization and the type and frequency of interactions between the intern(s) and employees. For example, what resources, facilities/equipment, and specialized training will the intern(s) have access to? If the intern(s) will work virtually, how will they be exposed to the activities and culture of the partner organization?

The Launch program taking place over a 4-month period. The program includes training sessions, workshops and activities designed for ambitious entrepreneurial students and research teams who are committed to forming, building, and growing ventures. The trainings and workshops are delivered through skills clinic and simulated Founder Council meetings

1. Trainings & Workshops- The Launch program contains a number of sessions designed to further the skill set of the interns to become a resilient innovator and entrepreneur, sessions include:

- Networking
- Legal and Financial Fundamentals (including financial reporting basics)
- Introduction to Founders Council
- Introduction to Design fundamentals
- Resilience Training
- Fundraising
- Presentation readiness
- Product building

2. Meetings

- Orientation and program kick-off meetings
- Weekly meeting among the team members (2 interns and mentor) and with other program participants (this is in addition to the sessions including lecture, skill clinic and workshops)
- Total of ~40 hours meeting with Founder Council throughout the
- Weekly 1 hr debrief session with Program Manager
- Pitch preparation
- Majority of core program is spent in achieving key deliverable a few outlined in the deliverables section

The interns as a team will be supported throughout the program by both the program facilitator and the Launch program Manager. The interns will be meeting with Entrepreneur-in-residence through weekly check-in meetings and scheduled office hour meetings.

The Launch Program Manager will meet with teams at the halfway point of the program and may meet additionally as needed to support the participant.

2.4 PAST/OTHER MITACS PROJECTS

Is this application related to, or a continuation of, any previous or current Mitacs projects? ☐ *Yes* ☐ *No*

*If **Yes**, provide specifics about the relationship(s), including relevant project IT#(s). If the current project is a continuation of prior work, briefly describe how it meaningfully furthers what has been previously achieved.*

Participating in the Mitacs funded Lab2Market Validate program became a major turning point in the evolution of Local Connect. Prior to entering the program, Local Connect primarily operated as a traditional wholesale and distribution business focused on connecting local farms and food producers with restaurants and grocers through warehousing, refrigerated delivery, and a custom ordering platform.

Through the Validate program, extensive customer discovery interviews were conducted with restaurants, distributors, suppliers, food hubs, and industry stakeholders across British Columbia. These conversations revealed that many of the challenges facing regional food systems were not simply logistical problems, but data problems. Producers often lacked visibility into what commercial buyers were actually purchasing, while buyers struggled to consistently source local products that matched their operational needs and pricing expectations.

As research progressed, it became increasingly clear that the largest distributors in Canada held an enormous competitive advantage through access to centralized purchasing data. Local producers, meanwhile, were making growing and production decisions with little understanding of real commercial demand. This disconnect created inefficiencies, food waste, missed sales opportunities, and significant barriers to scaling regional food systems.

These findings fundamentally shifted the direction of Local Connect. Rather than focusing solely on operating as another wholesaler, the company began developing a demand-driven reverse marketplace model centered around commercial purchasing intelligence. The goal evolved from simply moving products to building the underlying data infrastructure needed to support stronger regional supply chains.

The insights and validation gained through the Lab2Market Validate program ultimately led to acceptance into the Lab2Market Launch program, where Local Connect is now focused on building and piloting its reverse marketplace platform. The Launch phase represents the transition from validating the problem to actively developing scalable solutions that improve coordination between producers and commercial buyers within regional food systems.

2.5 ENGAGEMENT WITH INDIGENOUS COMMUNITIES OR PARTNERS (IF APPLICABLE)

Projects that involve or impact Indigenous communities must comply with the [Mitacs Indigenous Research Policy](). Describe (1) Indigenous community support for the project, and their role in shaping its objectives/approach, (2) plans for Indigenous community access, use, and governance of resulting knowledge/data, and (3) the team background in Indigenous research, including planned training/mentorship the intern(s) will receive to address deficits in experience.

You may also submit 1-2 letter(s) of support from Indigenous Elders who are members of the partner community/communities and possess the authority to speak on community interests.

Click or tap here to enter text.

2.6 INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY (IF APPLICABLE)

*Explain how this project supports the **creation and/or ownership of IP** for the partner organization. If the project provides **education or training about IP** for any of the participants, explain here.*

Click or tap here to enter text.

2.7 REFERENCES / SOURCES (IF APPLICABLE)

List any references you have cited in your proposal.

Click or tap here to enter text.

Appendix A: Application Guide

Introduction

All applicants must complete all sections of the application form. Please contact your Mitacs Advisor if you have questions. The approval criteria can be found in **Appendix B**. Individual projects are not expected to meet all the criteria. As you write your application, be sure to include information about those criteria that do apply to your project.

Application checklist (what you need to apply)

✔ This application form **completed and uploaded** to the RAP.

- All participants (intern, partner organization, academic supervisor) must create accounts in RAP and sign off on the project within RAP.

✔ Office of Research Services (ORS) or equivalent signature on the proposal.

- A signature template is provided as part of the RAP application process. The lead applicant on the proposal will be responsible for collecting the ORS or equivalent signature and uploading the signature page to RAP.
- Your academic institution must sign off on this proposal once all sections of the RAP are complete and all participants have signed off on the application. Instructions are provided in RAP.

Eligibility

Mitacs funds **research** and **innovation** projects. The BSI program focuses on **innovation projects**. Innovation projects are expected to lead to changes or improvements for the partner and/or community through exploration, design, and implementation of efficiencies in business models, products, processes, or services. Proposals should describe how the project will lead to economic, health and/or social benefits for the partner organization and/or the community and society at large.

Intern eligibility

- Post-secondary students are eligible for any number of internships at the discretion of their institution. Interns must be enrolled as a student at an eligible institution throughout the course of the internship and have time in their schedule to commit to the project.
- Postdoctoral fellows can do up to nine (9) four-month internships (up to three (3) years)
- Recent graduates can complete up to three (3) four-month internships within two years of their graduation date
- Interns may not participate in more than one internship at the same time.

Academic supervisor eligibility

Eligible academic supervisors are:

- professors at Canadian universities who are eligible to receive Tri-Agency funds
- faculty or appropriate research staff at Canadian colleges

The academic supervisor who signs the proposal may choose to involve other qualified staff individuals at the academic institution, such as program or research staff or senior graduate students and/or postdocs in the hands-on supervision of interns. Any such collaborators or informal co-supervisors do not need to be listed on the application form as supervisors, but their roles in supporting the intern(s) should be described in the proposal.

Partner organization eligibility

Eligible partner organizations are:

- for-profit corporations in Canada
- NFP organizations in Canada
    - Eligible NFPs include charities, economic development organizations, industry associations, social welfare organizations, health organizations, foundations, and research centers/institutes.
    - Projects with an NFP partner must demonstrate an economic or productivity orientation, which must be described in the proposal.
- municipalities
- hospitals

Collaboration

Collaboration is an essential feature of many Mitacs projects. BSI projects may involve a collaboration between:

- an **academic institution** and a **non-academic partner organization** that participates in and contributes funds to the project.
- These projects may be built in four- to six-month internship units, each valued at:
    - $10,000 with a $5,000 contribution from the partner organization; or
    - $15,000 with a $7,500 contribution from the partner organization.

Collaboration with non-academic organizations

Projects involving non-academic partner organizations (i.e., companies, eligible not-for-profits [NFPs]) require a true collaboration between the intern, their academic supervisor and institution, and the partner organization. The non-academic partner organization is not just a financial sponsor of the project; they are expected to participate in the development and completion of the project alongside the intern(s). In-person interaction at the partner's location is required when feasible, but we recognize that due to pandemic restrictions, many organizations began working virtually, and that this mode of work continues in some fields as part of the new normal. If the non-academic partner organization does not have a physical location where the intern can interact with their staff, be sure to clearly describe plans for virtual interaction. It is also important to note that Mitacs projects are not work placements or traditional co-ops. Academic supervisors (and/or other members of the supervisory team at the academic institution) are expected to play an active role in advising the intern throughout the project.

Appendix B: Selection Criteria

Mitacs will review applications to ensure that minimum requirements for completeness and project eligibility are met. For information about this, please refer to the submission checklist below.

Mitacs will also assess the benefits of the project in terms of: the economic and societal impact; the development and deployment of talent; and the establishment and support of collaborations. A project does not need to demonstrate benefits in each category (project, talent, and collaboration) since strength in one category can make up for weakness in another. Projects that demonstrate little or no benefit across all categories will not be approved by Mitacs.

In addition to assessing the benefits of a project, each project will also be reviewed to ensure that it does not contain any unmanageable risks in the categories of: feasibility, loss of talent or international assets from Canada, economic and national security risks, and adverse effects on humans, animals, and/or the environment. Projects with high risks must demonstrate correspondingly high benefits to Canada and risk mitigation measures should be included in the proposal to justify approval by Mitacs.

While the selection process is not currently competitive, if funding does become limited, Mitacs will prioritize approval based on the potential cumulative benefits of the project.

Requirements for all projects

- ❑ The description of the why (the background), the what (the objectives), the how (the approach), the when (the timelines), and the project outputs (the deliverables), must be clear for all projects.

Requirements for all collaborations

- ❑ Objectives must be aligned with the knowledge, skills, expertise, and needs of all participants.
- ❑ Each party's roles and responsibilities must be clear to all signatories on the application.
- ❑ Each party's expectations on deliverables, priorities, and time sensitivities must be clear to all signatories on the application.
- ❑ Agreement on intellectual property rights, ownership, royalties must be clear to all signatories on the application.

Requirements for all internships

- ❑ A structure must be in place to provide academic support that is appropriate to the level of the intern(s).
- ❑ There must be sufficient support / supervision from the internship host at the partner organization.
- ❑ There must be sufficient capacity at the internship host to manage the planned number of interns.

Requirements for all projects involving Indigenous peoples or communities

- ❑ Project must have the support of the affected communities and those who have rights or a stake in the endeavor.

- ❑ Indigenous communities must have been involved in shaping the project from inception, and Elders and Knowledge Holders must have been directly engaged.
- ❑ There must be clear agreement on Indigenous communities' access, use, and governance of resulting knowledge and data.
- ❑ The project team must demonstrate the capacity to engage with Indigenous communities or partners in line with appropriate guidelines, principles, and policies (for more information please refer to our Indigenous Research Guidelines).

Project

Examples of how a project can demonstrate potential economic and societal impacts include, but are not limited to:

- creating or commercializing Canadian technology/intellectual property
- discovering new and broadly applicable knowledge
- enhancing Canadian productivity by developing new and improved processes
- supporting the entry of Canadian businesses into new domestic/international markets
- developing new business models for Canadian companies
- improving public services (e.g. transportation infrastructure, utilities, healthcare) in Canada
- contributing new solutions to community challenges in Canada
- addressing social or environmental issues important to Canadian society
- advancing new approaches to include under-represented groups in the knowledge economy
- working towards a more equal and equitable Canada
- implementing evidence-informed strategies to address a specific challenge

Talent

Examples of how a project can demonstrate the potential for supporting the development of a talented and skilled population include, but are not limited to:

- interns gaining specialized technical skills through access to and training on the use of specialized equipment and facilities
- training interns in research skills
- training interns in interdisciplinary teamwork
- training interns in community-based methodologies
- training interns in entrepreneurial/professional skills through structured activities
- creating opportunities for interns to apply their knowledge / skills and solve industry/real-world problems
- re-skilling/up-skilling interns to pursue new and emerging opportunities in Canada
- placing interns in positions (at Canadian companies or organizations) appropriate to their training/skills
- interns being introduced to new professional experiences/environments/contacts/networks in Canada
- supporting individuals from under-represented groups in the knowledge economy

Collaboration

Examples of how a project can demonstrate the anticipated benefits associated with collaboration include, but are not limited to:

- bringing people together to solve problems through complementary skills and expertise
- sharing access to data, facilities, instruments for mutual benefit
- exchanging knowledge among academia, industry, communities
- moving tacit knowledge into practice through interdisciplinary teamwork
- supporting long-term relationships between academia, industry, communities
- establishing new collaborations between academia, industry, communities
- attracting foreign investment, talent, and innovative companies to Canada

- creating partnerships with communities that are under-represented in the knowledge economy
- linking Canadian researchers to prominent research groups globally